

RES-017 | PRINT EDITION | VERSION 1.0

Bookkeeping setup

Create a repeatable process for collecting records. Use account nicknames only.

Keep business and personal activity distinguishable. If they have been mixed, gather the records and ask a qualified professional how to document and correct the situation. Do not assume that a separate account alone completes your bookkeeping.

Do not enter account numbers, tax identification numbers, passwords, card details, or confidential customer information in this organizer. Store the completed file securely.

Business shorthand / period covered

Bookkeeping owner / backup person / professional contact role

Recording tool or software / where your master business details are kept

Accounts to separate or clarify / questions about mixed transactions

Accounting-method or setup questions to ask a professional

Accounts and payment channels

List all places money is received, held, or paid. Names and record locations are enough.

Account and channel map

Nickname / type	Statement or report location	Payout timing / record owner

Examples: business checking, business card, cash, online store, or payment processor. Keep processor reports alongside bank statements; a net payout may differ from sales because of fees, refunds, or timing. Avoid recording the sale and its bank payout as two sales.

Missing statements / access or export tasks / owner

Income and expense categories

Choose consistent labels that fit your activity. Confirm classification and tax treatment with a professional.

Income examples: product sales, service fees, subscriptions. Track refunds and discounts clearly. Transfers, owner contributions, and loan proceeds need separate treatment from sales; ask how they should be recorded.

Income labels to use / refunds or adjustments to track

Expense examples: supplies, software, advertising, rent, professional services, payment fees. A bookkeeping label does not establish deductibility. Ask about inventory, equipment, mixed-use purchases, and owner withdrawals.

Expense labels to use / items needing professional clarification

How will you connect each entry to its supporting record?

Receipt storage and recurring routines

Keep records findable and assign a realistic routine. A receipt alone may not explain the business purpose.

Storage location / folder structure / file naming rule

Who can access records? Backup process / retention question

Weekly routine

- ☐ Gather sales reports, invoices, receipts, and other supporting records from all channels.
- ☐ Record or import transactions and check for missing records or duplicates.
- ☐ Add business context to unclear transactions and list questions instead of guessing.
- ☐ Review unpaid customer invoices and upcoming bills where applicable.

Monthly routine

- ☐ Collect bank, card, and processor statements for the period.
- ☐ Compare recorded activity with statements and resolve or flag differences.
- ☐ Review income and expense labels consistently and inspect unusual items.
- ☐ Back up records and prepare the month-end questions for professional review.

Weekly day / monthly review date / routine owner

Month-end review

A bank balance alone is not a profit measure. Use your actual records and the help appropriate for your business.

Month / review owner / records through date

Before closing your review

- ☐ All relevant account and payment-channel statements have been gathered.
- ☐ Missing documents, unclear entries, and duplicate transactions have been identified.
- ☐ Differences between processor reports, recorded sales, and deposits have been explained or flagged.
- ☐ Unpaid invoices, bills, and unusual income or expenses have been reviewed where applicable.

What do the records suggest about income, expenses, and cash timing?

Unresolved items / supporting record needed / owner

Next action / due date / professional review needed

Questions for your professional

Use this page to prepare a focused conversation. Keep notes about the answer and the next step.

Possible questions: Which accounting method fits my situation? How should I record mixed transactions, processor fees, refunds, inventory, or equipment? Which records should I retain and for how long? What needs correction before reporting or filing?

Bookkeeper / accountant / tax professional questions

Question / context	Answer / who and when	Next action / owner / date

Notes / follow-up appointment or review date

Use, save, and keep learning

Small Business Bookkeeping Basics Organizer

Use your existing business master sheet for identity details. Map where financial records come from and where they are stored, then schedule weekly and monthly routines. This organizer is not a ledger or a tax calculator.

Using the digital edition

Download first and open in a PDF reader that supports AcroForm fields. Save a copy after entering your information. Test one field and reopen the saved file before completing the tool. Long text may scroll within a field, so keep notes concise and check print preview. Repeat only the pages you need for each new period.

Educational use

Educational organization only, not accounting, tax, legal, or individualized financial advice. Categories are examples, not deduction guidance. Ask a qualified bookkeeper, accountant, or tax professional about your records, accounting method, tax treatment, and retention requirements.

Connected NINZ tools

Business Information Master Sheet

<https://ninz.me/resources/business-information-master-sheet/>

Business Compliance Calendar Template

<https://ninz.me/resources/business-compliance-calendar-template/>

Funding Readiness Checklist

<https://ninz.me/resources/funding-readiness-checklist/>

Learning Center: <https://ninz.me/learning-center.html>

IRS: recordkeeping for small businesses (checked October 4, 2026)

<https://www.irs.gov/businesses/small-businesses-self-employed/recordkeeping>